Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor



Check your Calendars

The November Meeting is Sunday, November 9, 1997 – 1:30 PM

AND NOT NOVEMBER 2.

At City Hall

AND NOT THE SENIOR CENTER

The Mountain View Historical Association will be joining with the City of Mountain View for our November meeting. The City held its Diamond Jubilee in 1977, and had such a good time that it has had a party every ten years since. This is the 95th anniversary of the Incorporation of Mountain View as a Municipal Corporation. Barbara Kinchen has provided a review of the people and actions which led to that event, and she has set the stage with a review of the other happenings of that year as reported in the local newspapers.

The first two floors of City Hall will be decorated with pictures and other memorabilia. The speakers will all be talking about the early history of Mountain View. This as a sort of warmup for the Centenial Celebration in 2002.. Join with us. Refreshments will be served..

Barbecue & Raffle

The August Meeting

August was the Annual Barbecue & Raffle for the Mountain View Historical Association. We assembled in the Patio Area of the Mountain View Senior Center. The weather was glorious California, and we had enough umbrellas to provide some shade. There were about one hundred of us in attendance. Art Walton's potato salad was up to expectations, and Al Jehning flips hamburgers like a professional. We had apple pie and ice cream, and there were baked beans and salad. Everything for a great traditional picnic! The musicians were able to dredge up all of those great old songs from back when we were young and dating. There were dozens of great prizes for the Raffle, and I am going to keep going back until I win something!

The Event could not have been the success it was without the generous support of many businesses and individuals. You will find the list of people and organizations that contributed in the Newsletter, but ultimately this kind of thing happens because a few individuals work very hard. A few of those people are Ralph and Art and Al and Wally and Edna and Bobby, and they drafted family and friends. It was a team effort, and great fun, and we will do it again.

MTN. VIEW INCORPORATED 95 YEARS A CITY

BY BARBARA MCPHEETERS KINCHEN

Mountain View became a Municipal Corporation of the sixth class on November 7, 1902.

Gustavus K. Estes, lawyer and editor-publisher of the Register, was the principal backer of incorporation. He urged citizens to support it because of financial advantages. Some $2,000 a year was going into the county treasury from local road taxes and business licenses. Estes estimated that $1,000 was enough to run the town, including sprinkling all the streets, and there would be money enough for improvements like a park and a library.

Following the procedures prescribed by law, a petition was prepared and circulated. Signed by seventy-two supporters, it was presented to Santa Clara County Board of Supervisors in August of 1902. Benjamin E. Burns and Walter A. Clark, both influential businessmen of Mountain View, accompanied Mr. Estes to the formal hearing in September. No one appeared in opposition and so a special incorporation election was ordered for Saturday, November 1, 1902.

Polls were open from 6:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. at Olympic Hall, at the corner of Castro and Front Streets. Front Street is now Evelyn Avenue. Registered voters within the proposed town limits voted for or against incorporation and, at the same time, indicated choices for five trustees and three officers.

There were 156 votes cast, 88 for incorporation and 64 against, with four rejected for "irregularities." Elected as Town Trustees were Benjamin E. Burns, Daniel B. Frink, Dr. Charles O. Gates, M.D., George A. Pattberg and George Swall. Paul J. Schwab had the most votes for Town Clerk and ex-officio Assessor. Alvin Rogers was selected as Treasurer and Richard C. Waits won as Marshall and ex-officio Tax and License Collector.

Supervisors canvassed the vote and forwarded an order for incorporation to the Secretary of State where it was received and officially stamped November 7, 1902.

The Board of Trustees and elected officers met for the first time at 7:30 p.m. on November 10 in the law offices of B.E. Burns. After electing Mr. Frink as President, Ordinance No. 1 was introduced and adopted which set amounts for bonds required for the three officers. Committees were then appointed to design a seal and to draft ordinances. The hand-written minutes show that before adjourning "a contribution of one dollar each was given by each member of the Board & Officers-elect and placed in the hands of the Treasurer."

The sketch following this article shows the 1902 town limits. Within the area of approximately one square mile the population count was 610.

Pop Smith, editor of the Mountain View Register-Leader, wrote in 1927 that the 1902 boundary lines had been carefully drawn so as to exclude some areas populated by incorporation objectors and to include large orchards whose owners favored forming a town. The small area defined by San Jose Road, Montgomery and Centre was the school lot on which had been a grammar school since 1858 and, now, the high school building just opened in September of 1902.

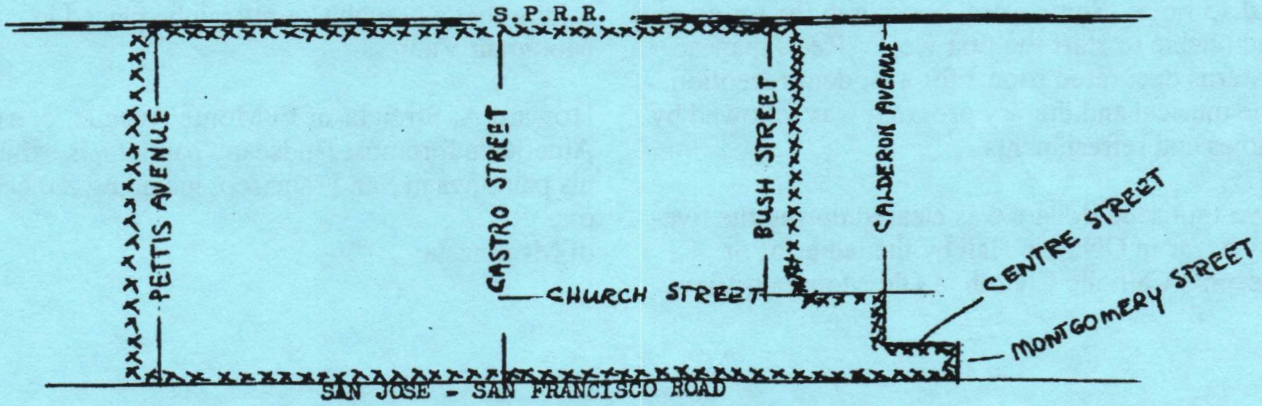
The Mountain View Historical Association sponsored the 75th anniversary of incorporation with a Diamond Jubilee Meeting on November 6, 1977. Panel members told of happenings in the past and Victor Calvo, at that time an Assemblyman, presented certificates to more than 40 invited guests who had been living in and near Mountain View in 1902. Rengstorff Community Center auditorium was filled with members, guests, friends and representatives from city and community organizations. As befitted birthday celebrations, there was a very large and beautifully decorated cake for all to enjoy.

Maryce Freelen was chairwoman for the party on November 7, 1987. An estimated crowd of 7,000 gathered on Castro Street where merchants, schools, organizations and industries arranged exhibits and activities for all ages. These included a gallery of old photos, a walking tour, displays in historic downtown buildings, stagecoach rides, music by two bands and painting of a mural at

Castro and California Streets. A biplane towed a birthday greeting sign overhead.

Special ceremonies at 2:00 p.m. under a big tent featured cutting the two 4X8 foot birthday cakes by Mayor Bob Scats, assisted by honored guest, Mrs. Helen Horton Madden, 93 years old life-long resident.

Now, after another decade of growth and change, it is again time to celebrate and learn, or recall, our local history. And it's not too early to begin planning for that biggie in 2002 – our 100th birthday.



OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS

BY BARBARA MCPHEETERS KINCHEN

95 Years Ago (1902): The Mountain View Band, directed by W.A. Platt, presented open air concerts on Saturday evenings.

Native Sons of the Golden West organized a local parlor with charter membership of 24.

The Post Office was robbed of $100 cash and stamps worth $600. During the night the door was forced open and dynamite used to blow open the safe.

Becoming independent because of demand for their services, Chinese fruit pickers were asking pay equal to white workers.

A brickyard worker was seriously hurt when dirt fell on him as he was in the pit digging clay.

The West Santa Clara Valley Railroad Promotion Club was formed to promote a railroad through Cupertino and on to Saratoga and Los Gatos. Mountain View was one of the suggested connections with the Southern Pacific tracks.

Double tracks from San Francisco to San Jose were completed in 1902 by Southern Pacific.

There were 344 children of school age (5-17) within Mountain View School District and 38 living in Whisman School District.

It was reported that 8 students from Mountain View and 1 from Whisman passed examination or were honorary pupils and were promoted to 8th grade. For promotion to 8th grade and for a diploma from 8th grade, students had to be in the top half of their class in an accredited school or pass examinations given in San Jose by the County Board of Education. It took two Saturday sessions for tests covering the following subjects: arithmetic, spelling, history, civil government, mental

arithmetic, grammar, composition, reading word analysis, drawing and bookkeeping.

The contract for building a two-story high school building next to the grammar school went to William H. Bates for his low bid of $7,338. Started in May, it was completed in time for opening on September 1st. Professor Samuel P. McCrea and Miss Alice Williston, both Stanford grads, were in charge of the 19 freshmen, 5 sophomores and 2 juniors – 13 girls and 13 boys. Some were working in the prune crop and unable to start the first week. Red Japanese lanterns decorated rooms for a student reception. The musical and literary program was followed by games and refreshments.

Two thousand dollars was cleared during the five-day bazar in Olympic Hall by the ladies of St. Joseph's Catholic Church in Old Mountain View. Parishioners were raising money for a new building at Hope and Church Streets, next to their newly constructed parsonage.

On Christmas afternoon the Cyclers' Club played the high school football team and won 5 to 0. (5 touchdowns?)

A petition was sent to the Board of Supervisors asking that a branch County jail be placed in Mountain View.

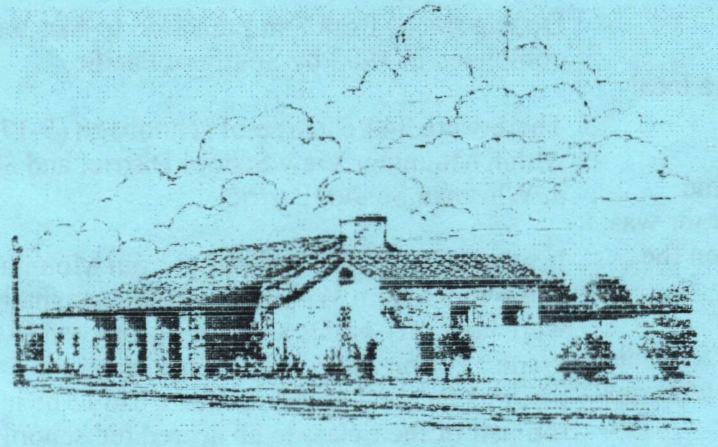
Howard A. Streight of El Monte Avenue, one of America's foremost landscape painters, is exhibiting his paintings in San Francisco, including a recent one of Mt. Shasta.

Save The Adobe

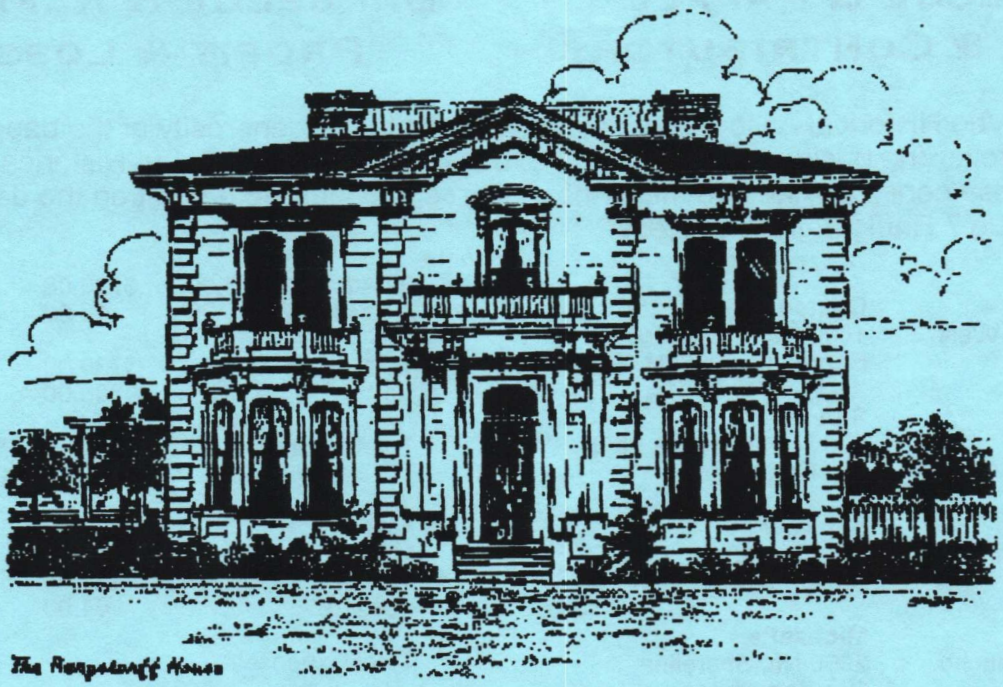
Mountain View was only three decades old when the Adobe was built. It is the last remaing public building of any significance left in the area.. It was a building built with style and grace, designed to bridge the transition from old mountain view and our Spanish traditions and the modern world.

It would be very appropriate if the Adobe could grace this primary entrance into downtown Mountain View when we celebrate our 100th aniversary.

The building sits almost at the terminus of the light rail system as it will exist in 2002, and that makes it seem a particularly appropriate symbol of the old and the new, and our connections to our roots.



SAVE
THE
ADOBE



Old and Precious

This graceful old home now overlooks Shoreline Regional Park. It embodies a good deal of Mountain View's history, and it is very much too the credit of the community that they chose to preserve it. It provides an island of calm in our midst, and an opportunity to reflect upon just how we got here, and where we have been.

We are a multi-cultural society now, and in particular here where generations of peoples have come for the agricultural work, for the climate, for the high tech work. We are red, yellow, brown and white in our roots, and soon there will be no one race or nationality which constitutes a plurality.

If you haven't visited Rengstorff House you are missing out on some important insights in too who we are. For these very reasons we also need to preserve the Adobe.

1997 Annual Barbecue & Raffle Donors & Contributors

The Mountain Vue Historical Association is grateful to the following businesses and individuals whose generosity helped make the annual Barbecue 7 Raffle a great success:

Chevy's
2116 El Camino West
Gift Certificate

Costco
1000 No. Rengstorff
Hamburger Patties, Buns

Safeway
1750 Miramonte
Salad Fixings

Safeway
570 No. Shoreline Blvd
Gift Certificate

Nob Hill Market
1350 Grant Road
Gift Certificate

Safeway
2500 California
Apple Pies

Andronico's
690 Los Altos Rancho
Ice Cream

Michael's
2960 No. Shoreline
Gift Certificates

Walmart
600 Showers Drive
Gift Certificate

Golden Wok
895 Villa Street
Gift Certificates

Burrito Real
580 No. Rengstorff
Gift Certificates

Bueno Burrito
2500 El Camino
Gift Certificates

Clarke's
615 El Camino
Gift Certificates

Baskin Robbins
1249 W. El Camino
Gift

Baskin Robbins
730 E. El Camino
Gift Certificates

Lucky's
580 No. Rengstorff
Gift Certificates

See's Candies
4844 El Camino
Gift Certificates

Crown Book Stores
590 Showers Drive
Gift Certificates

Orchard Supply
2555 Charleston
Gift Certificates

Chili's
2560 W. El Camino
Gift Certificates

Al Jehning
561 Carl Ct.
Charcoal

Art Walton
3554 Parkland Drive
Potato Salad

Ralph Faravelli
1870 Walnut Drive
Condiments

1997 Annual Barbecue & Raffle Profit & Loss

Thanks to the generosity of the people and businesses on the left, the Historical Association turned a profit on the day.

Income:			
	90 Adults @ $ 8.00	$720.00	
	3 Children @ $ 5.00	15.00	
	Total	$730.00	
	Raffle	306.00	
	Total Income		$1041.00
Expenses:			
	Pies	$ 23.96	
	Music	75.00	
	Flyers	120.00	
	Postage	64.00	
	Total Expenses		283.11
Profit			$ 757.89

MEMBERSHIP REPORT

Reported by Edna Thompson

A list of members of the Mountain View Historical Association is available to members from the Chair of the Membership Committee. Dues are $ 7.00 per year for an individual or $10.00 per year for a family, and Life Membership is $100.00 per person.

Life Members	51.
Special Members	2.
Honored Member	1.
Individual and Family Members	206.
Total	260.

New Life Members (Since last Newsletter)
- J. R. Stafford
- Brigitte Stafford

New Individual and Family Members
- May Thoza Bontempi
- Carl and Elsie Brown
- Kevin and Roberta Duggan
- Betty C. Monroe
- Robert and Dorothy Moore

LIFE MEMBERS

Mario Ambra
Lawrence Anderson
Dena K. Bonnell
Hilton Brown
Reynolds Camp
Cliff Del Carlo
Alfred P. Chasuk
Ruth Erichsen
Wallace Erichsen
Carmen Farvelli
Ralph Faravelli
Roger Fellows
Patricia Figueroa
Marion Grimm
Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger
Bill Henderson
Eleanor McGlynn Henderson
Charles Hirschbek
DeWitt Hogle
Norene Hogle
Alice D. Holden
George Holden
George Jagels
Al Jehning
Robert W. Kirby
Joe Kleitman
Helen Shearer Krogh
Holly Urban Moore Leonard
Kenneth Richard Malovos
Madeline Chargon Malovos
Eva Mockbee
Gail Urban Moore
Mimi Mourkas
Patricia J. Reyburn
Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Nancy L. Smith
Richard M. Smith
Martin J. Spangler
Honor Spitz
J. R. Stafford
Brigitte Stafford
H. Lee Stillers
Linda Swan
Joseph Sweeney
Roberta Sweeney
Edna Thompson
Sally Moore Taboada
John Viscovich
Arthur Walton
Patricia Walton
Bill Wissell

ASSOCIATION OFFICERS AND BOARD MEMBERS

President	Ralph Faravelli
Past President & Social	Wally Erichsen
Vice President	Arthur Walton
Secretary	Eva Mockbee
Treasurer	June de Larios
Membership	Edna Thompson
Newsletter & Program	Hilton Brown
Hospitality	Mary Esther Walton
Memorial/Remembrance	Edna Thompson
Ways & Means	Joseph Sweeney
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification/Recording	Albert Jehning

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting. Short items on appropriate topics submitted by any member of the Association will be considered for publication.

TREASURER'S REPORT
A.J. DE LARIOS

Balance 7/1/97		$10,458.66
Income:		
Membership	$297.00	
Sales	21.00	
BBQ	997.00	
Adobe Fund	0.00	
Memorial Fund	50.00	
Interest	16.00	
Total Income		$1,381.00
Expenses:		
Administration	$197.39	
BBQ	23.96	
Total Expenses		$ 221.35
Balance 9/30/97		$11,618.31

Fund Balances:

Adobe Fund	$2,603.43
Memorial Fund	275.00
Life Member Fund	5,100.00
General Fund	3,639.88

Investment:
$5,000, 9 month CD, 6.02%, matures 12/26/97

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
SPECIAL MEETING

Sunday, November 9, 1997
1:30 PM
Council Chambers
Mountain View City Hall

A Celebration
--
The First 95 Years

Presented by
The City of Mountain View

MEMBERSHIP: Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

AIMS: The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

_____

_____

TELEPHONE: _____

NEW___RENEWAL___Regular Member $ 7.00/yr
Family Membership $10.00/yr, Life Member $100.00.
Make Check Payable to:
Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

MOUNTAIN VIEW
HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. BOX 252
MOUNTAIN VIEW, CA 94042

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